song, which embodies everything our country stands for, so stirringly played by a Soviet orchestra, was an emotional moment that is indescribable. Around us were our respective teams of advisors, experts and aides—but for a few moments, at least, official business was far from our minds as we were treated to a performance by one of the world's truly great cultural institutions.

After we returned to Washington, I sent a letter to Gorbachev thanking him for his hospitality and expressing pleasure at the evolution of our relationship. In his reply, Gorbachev agreed: "Indeed, along with significant political results, our meetings in Moscow have been given an encouraging human dimension—not only in terms of our personal liking for each other, but also in terms of warmer relations between our peoples and their more correct perception of each other. The importance of all this transcends even the U.S.-Soviet dialogue."